

Rihito Arai

Senior Software Engineer

Nagano, Japan
M +81 (90) 7948-0077
E licht.e.jima@gmail.com
in rihito
gh rhty

Professional Summary

A hands-on **Senior Software Engineer and CTO** with **7+ years** of experience building backend platforms and AI-enabled products with **Go and TypeScript**. Leads product architecture and delivery across LLM pipelines, backend services, cloud infrastructure, and internal tools. Proven track record of designing multitenant access-control architectures, improving testing and release processes in legacy systems, and taking products from requirements to production. Effective at bridging business and engineering teams in bilingual, cross-cultural environments, with professional experience in both Japan and Canada.

Availability

Available from August 2026 for fully remote engagements. Seeking project-based full-time contracts of up to six months, or longer-term part-time work of approximately 25 hours per week. Particularly interested in opportunities with English-speaking international teams.

Key Skills

Backend & Languages	Go, TypeScript (NestJS), Ruby, Python, Google Apps Script
AI & Data	Multi-model LLM pipeline design, OpenAI / Anthropic / Google APIs, data warehouse pipelines, AI-assisted data operations
Frontend	React, Angular, shadcn/ui, MUI
Infrastructure & DevOps	AWS, GCP (Cloud Run, GKE, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub, Cloud Build, Firebase), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Datadog, Sentry, Fastly, Cloudflare
Databases	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL, Redis, DynamoDB
Architecture & Security	Microservices, multitenancy, ACL / RBAC, encryption and compliance for sensitive personal data
APIs & Integrations	REST, OpenAPI / Swagger, gRPC, GraphQL, OAuth 2.0, Stripe, Ory Keto / Kratos
Quality & Leadership	Technical leadership, CI/CD, legacy refactoring, test strategy, code review, Scrum Master
Languages	Japanese (Native), English (Business; 3+ years of professional experience), Spanish (Beginner)

Work Experience

- Apr 2026 – Present **CTO, VisionCompass Inc.**, Japan (Remote)
- Lead backend, infrastructure, AI, and admin-platform development for **Neruzo**, an AI-powered journaling and sleep application launched on July 13, 2026.
 - Architected and implemented a flexible, graph-based LLM pipeline with configurable nodes and conditional branching across OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google models to summarize journals, analyze conversations, and organize users' thought patterns.
 - Built a Dockerized Go backend on GCP Cloud Run with Supabase, plus a React and shadcn/ui administration platform.
 - Implemented database-backed asynchronous processing with polling Cloud Run workers and concurrent execution to use LLM API wait time efficiently.
- Aug 2025 – Jul 2026 **Software Engineer (Contract), COTEN Inc.**, Japan (Remote)
- Designed and implemented AI-powered Google Sheets tooling in TypeScript and Google Apps Script, automating world-history data curation tasks that were impractical to perform manually.
 - Led the design and implementation of multitenancy, organization models, and ACLs for a data-warehouse-as-a-service platform.
 - Designed and implemented data pipelines and backend APIs using TypeScript and NestJS.
 - Managed a Bangladesh-based engineering team and collaborated on the technical design of a React administration UI migration from MUI to shadcn/ui.
- Jan 2025 – Oct 2025 **Senior Applications Developer, CIBC (Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce)**, Toronto, Canada (Hybrid)
- Developed and stabilized an internal corporate-security case-management and assessment platform using Go, TypeScript / Angular, MSSQL, and Windows Server.
 - Gained stakeholder support to include refactoring and automated testing in the delivery plan, helping the team achieve stable releases with few observed errors.
 - Improved Jenkins pipelines and standardized the release workflow, reducing friction and risk during deployments.
 - Proposed and implemented internal API improvements, including new schemas and reverse-proxy integration between legacy and new systems; also identified security and data-consistency issues.
 - Contributed to a delivery recognized by department leadership as its most successful project, while mentoring junior engineers through backend and CI/CD knowledge-sharing sessions.

- Nov 2021 – Feb 2025 **Senior Software Engineer / (Acting) Tech Lead**, *WealthPark Co., Ltd.*, Tokyo, Japan (Remote)
- Built a Go (go-kit) access-control microservice on AWS EKS with Ory Keto and developed Python / Airflow / AWS Lambda pipelines for external real estate data.
 - **Alternative Investment Project (Apr 2022 – Feb 2025):**
 - Joined at inception, clarified ambiguous requirements, and implemented investor registration and fund management features with Go microservices and gRPC.
 - Led four engineers and introduced unit testing and code review practices, raising overall coverage from 30% to ~ 70% and new-feature coverage to ~ 90%.
 - Dealt with MyNumber data (similar to SIN), ensuring encryption and compliance with government regulations.
 - Operated in an English-speaking environment, bridging communications between global dev teams and Japanese stakeholders.
- Jun 2019 – Oct 2021 **Server-Side and Research Engineer / Scrum Master**, *WED, inc.*, Tokyo
- Built and maintained backend services in Go, Ruby on Rails, Python on GCP.
 - Resolved critical concurrency issues in a high-traffic money management service (~ 100K MAU), preventing data inconsistency before it impacted end users.
 - Served as Scrum Master, introducing agile ceremonies, code review guidelines, and linting tools to reduce bottlenecks and enhance team autonomy.
- Oct 2018 – Jun 2019 **Intern Server-Side Engineer**, *FiNC Technologies, Inc.*, Tokyo, Japan
- Developed REST APIs with Ruby on Rails for health/fitness mobile apps.
 - Integrated OAuth2.0-based social logins (LINE, Facebook).
 - Gained foundational skills in microservice design, DB architecture, and user authentication.
- Feb 2020 – Present **Freelance / Side Projects**
- **Enterprise LLM Pipeline and Admin Tooling (TypeScript, Ruby on Rails, Google Apps Script):** Collaborated with a startup client to improve internal LLM workflows and develop custom admin tooling. Enhanced pipeline reliability and developer UX by organizing legacy scripts and adding new UI components.
 - **Meditation App Backend (Ruby on Rails, GCP):** Single-handedly built user management and audio content features; deployed via Terraform on GCP.

Education

- Sep 2021 **M.Eng. in Electrical Engineering & Information Systems**, *The University of Tokyo*, Tokyo, Japan
- Researched entity matching algorithms for receipts (Python, ML).
- Mar 2017 **B.Eng. in Applied Physics**, *Hokkaido University*, Hokkaido, Japan
- Studied complex network theory and computational methods (Fortran).